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GREECE WILDFIRE SENDS PEOPLE FLEEING

■ Firemen battle a wildfire that broke out in Ierapetra at the southern Greek island of Crete, yesterday. The forest fire fanned by gale-force winds in the holiday island led to the evacuation of locals and tourists, officials said. Greece is in the midst of a heatwave that is searing large chunks of Europe.

SEE ALSO P11

Dubai among world's top 3 most scenic cities after dark

Noctourism, a major travel trend this year, is changing how people explore the world

DUBAI
BY CHRISTIAN BORBON
Senior Web Editor

Dubai has been ranked the third most scenic city globally to explore at night, according to new research by travel experts at Travelbag. The study highlights how noctourism, one of 2025's biggest travel trends, is reshaping the way people travel. Interest in after-dark adventures has soared, with Google searches for nighttime tourism activities spiking by 164 per cent this year.

Travelbag's team analysed more than 100 major cities worldwide, measuring Instagram hashtag activity, levels of light and noise pollution,

TOP 10 CITIES

- New York, USA
- Tokyo, Japan
- Dubai, UAE
- Singapore city, Singapore
- Muscat, Oman
- Kyoto, Japan
- Sydney, Australia
- Seoul, South Korea
- Toronto, Canada
- Melbourne, Australia

nighttime safety scores, and the number of late-night venues.

Safety and style

Dubai stood out for its blend of safety and style. The city's glittering skyline and nightlife scene have inspired 29,600 Instagram hashtags. With a strong nighttime safety score of 83 and a moderate light

and noise pollution rating of 53, Dubai offers visitors a secure and glamorous setting for nighttime exploration. Its 190 late-night venues focus on luxury, elegance, and after-dark experiences.

New York claimed the top spot, with over 40,800 Instagram hashtags showcasing its iconic skyline and a massive 2,300+ late-night venues. Tokyo took second place, earning praise for its balance of low light pollution (score: 46), high safety (75), and vibrant nightlife across nearly 1,000 venues.

Abu Dhabi has been ranked the safest city in the world for exploring after dark, earning a standout nighttime safety score of 87 out of 100 in Travelbag's global study of long-haul destinations.

Close behind is Taipei, Taiwan, with a safety score of 85, followed by Dubai at 83 – both solid choices for those seeking secure and enjoyable after-dark experiences.

10-year-old uses police app to report father's cruelty

Dubai Police promptly warn parent, assure support to boy

DUBAI
BY AGHADDIR ALI
Senior Reporter

When a 10-year-old boy in Dubai gathered the courage to report his father for repeated beatings, he did it quietly – through the Dubai Police smart app. He didn't know what he had done to deserve the bruises he was trying to hide from his classmates.

Dubai Police shared the story of the boy, identified only as A.A., as a reminder that help is always available. In line with the UAE's Child Rights Law, known as the Wadeema Law, the General Department of

Human Rights encourages everyone to report abuse quickly.

Lieutenant Colonel Dr. Ali Al Matrooshi, Director of the Child and Women Protection Department, said, "The child was afraid to speak up".

Didn't mean to cause harm

After receiving the report, the police called in the boy's father. During questioning, the father admitted to hitting his son but said he never meant to cause harm. "He thought that being strict would prepare his son for life," Al Matrooshi said. The police explained to the father that his methods were harmful – and illegal. The father pledged to change.

Al Matrooshi added that Dubai Police will provide the child with emotional support and counselling in partnership with social services.

UAE 3rd largest sovereign fund holder globally

COUNTRY LEADS MIDDLE EAST WITH \$2.49 TRILLION IN NATIONAL WEALTH

DUBAI
BY KHITAM AL AMIR
Chief News Editor

The UAE now ranks third globally in terms of total sovereign wealth and public pension assets, according to the Global SWF mid-year report for 2025.

The UAE holds a combined \$2.49 trillion (Dh9.17 trillion) in sovereign-owned investor (SOI) assets, making it the largest holder in the Middle East and third worldwide – behind only the United States with \$12.12 trillion, and China, with \$3.36 trillion.

Sovereign-owned investors include both sovereign wealth funds (SWFs) and public pension funds. The UAE's position reflects the performance of a wide network of government-owned investment institutions.

Leading the way are the Abu Dhabi Investment Authority (ADIA), Mubadala Investment Company, ADQ, and the Investment Corporation of Dubai. Other contributors include the Emirates Investment Authority, Sharjah Asset Management, RAK Investment Authority, and Dubai World, among others.

Diversified portfolios

These entities manage highly diversified global portfolios spanning sectors such as energy, infrastructure, technology, logistics, and increasingly, clean

\$58.8b

deployed by global sovereign wealth funds in H1-2025

energy, AI, biotechnology, and sustainable industries.

Sovereign wealth funds have been central to the country's transition toward a more diversified, post-oil economy. This strategy includes increasing participation in global capital markets and forging strategic investment partnerships around the world.

133 deals globally

Global sovereign wealth funds deployed \$58.8 billion across 133 deals in the first half of 2025, according to the latest Global SWF report. Middle Eastern SWFs, primarily from the GCC, accounted for 36 per cent of that total, up from 32 per cent in the second half of 2024.

Mubadala and the Abu Dhabi Investment Authority (ADIA) ranked among the world's 10 most active sovereign investors during the period, investing \$9.6 billion and \$4.5 billion, respectively. Mubadala placed second globally, while ADIA ranked 10th.

In comparison, Mubadala was the top global SWF investor in 2024, deploying \$29.2 billion.

MIDDLE EAST

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